A CAREER STARTER GUIDE · FOR FRESH GRADUATES

Stand Out. Get Read. *Get Hired.*

প্রথম চাকরির সিভি: সফটওয়্যার পড়বে, মানুষ মনে রাখবে।

How to write an ATS-friendly CV, review it like a recruiter, and get noticed beyond the PDF.



Plain words · Real before & after · Beyond the PDF

Readable by machines. Memorable to humans.

A GUIDE BY ONNOY · অন্বয়

Stand Out. Get Read. Get Hired.

The fresh graduate's guide to an ATS-friendly CV, and to standing out beyond it

প্রথম চাকরির সিভি: সহজ ভাষায়, ধাপে ধাপে

FIRST EDITION	October 2026. Published in Mymensingh, Bangladesh.
PUBLISHED BY	Onnoy - অন্বয়, a youth-led decision-making mentorship initiative for students, parents and teachers.
TYPE	Playfair Display and DM Sans. Bangla set in Noto Sans Bengali.
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A NOTE ON FACTS	Hiring software, job sites and AI tools change often. Use this guide to learn how to think, then check the details on each employer's own site.
FIND US	Onnoy on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for "Onnoy".

Before You Begin

You've finished your degree. Now everyone talks about "CVs", "ATS-friendly résumés", "LinkedIn" and "portfolios", but nobody explains what these words mean or how hiring actually works. This book does.

Who this book is for

- Final-year students and fresh graduates in **any field**
- Anyone applying for a first job or internship, locally or remotely
- Seniors, mentors and friends who **review** CVs for others

How to read it

- **One page = one idea.** Read a page, then act on it.
- First time? Go in order, Part 1 to Part 6.
- In a hurry? Read p. 15, p. 27, p. 35 and p. 38.

The coloured boxes

DO THIS
What to do.

AVOID
Common mistakes.

TIP
Shortcuts and extra tips.

IN PLAIN WORDS
Jargon explained simply.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE
The unwritten rules of the professional world that nobody tells graduates.

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How Hiring Actually Works

Before writing a CV, it helps to know where it goes. Most applications follow this path:

1. **A job is posted** on the company's careers page, LinkedIn or job boards.
2. **You apply.** You upload your CV (sometimes a cover letter) and fill in a form.
3. **Software sorts it.** An ATS reads, stores and often ranks your CV against the job.
4. **A recruiter screens it.** A person skims the best matches, often in seconds.
5. **Screening call.** A 15–30 minute phone or video chat to check your interest, availability, salary expectations and communication.
6. **Interviews.** With your future manager and team. There may be a test, task or case study.
7. **Offer.** Salary, start date and contract. It is normal to ask questions before accepting.

IN PLAIN WORDS

Your CV doesn't get you the job. Its only job is to get you **from step 2 to step 5**: a conversation with a real person.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Hiring usually takes **2–8 weeks**. A week or two of silence is normal and doesn't mean you've been rejected. Keep applying elsewhere while you wait.

Who Reads Your CV?

Your CV has several readers. Each one wants something different.

The ATS (software)

Wants clean, readable text and the words that match the job. It cannot "see" design, colours or images.

The recruiter

An HR or "talent acquisition" person filling many jobs at once. Usually **not an expert** in your field. Wants quick proof that you meet the job's must-haves.

The hiring manager

Your future boss and an expert in the work. Wants evidence you can do the tasks, learn fast and fit the team.

HR / People team

Handles contracts, salary, policies and paperwork. May verify documents and call your references.

Small companies

Often no ATS at all. The founder or a manager reads everything personally, so clarity matters even more.

TIP

Write so a **non-expert** understands you in 7 seconds, and an **expert** respects you after 2 minutes.

Words You'll Hear

Job hunting comes with its own vocabulary. Here's what the common terms really mean.

CV / Résumé	A document summarising your education, skills and experience. In most of the world they mean the same thing. (In academia, a "CV" is a much longer record.) This book treats them as one.
ATS	*Applicant Tracking System*. Software that collects, reads, searches and ranks applications.
JD / Job post	*Job description*. The advert listing duties and requirements.
Requirements	Must-haves. Often titled "Required", "Minimum" or "Essential".
Nice-to-have	Bonus skills: "Preferred", "Desirable", "A plus". Optional.
Entry-level	Also *graduate, junior, associate, fresher*. Jobs meant for people with roughly 0–2 years' experience.
Keywords	The specific skills, tools and terms in a job post that software and recruiters search for.
Hard skills	Teachable, testable abilities: Excel, accounting, Python, graphic design, a language.

More Words You'll Hear

Soft skills	How you work with people and tasks: communication, teamwork, problem-solving. Prove them with examples instead of listing them.
Cover letter	A short letter (3–4 paragraphs) on why you want *this* job and why you fit it.
Portfolio	A collection of your work samples: projects, designs, writing, code, campaigns.
Shortlist	The small group of candidates chosen for interviews.
Referral	When someone who works at the company recommends you internally. Referred candidates are far more likely to get an interview.
Networking	Building professional relationships, mostly by asking people for *advice* (not for jobs).
References	People (a professor, internship supervisor) an employer may call to check on you. Always ask their permission first.
Screening call	A short first call with a recruiter before real interviews.
Notice period	How soon you can start. Graduates can often start immediately, which is an advantage.
Ghosting	When a company stops replying. Common, frustrating and almost never personal.

Meet the ATS: The Robot Reader

Most medium and large employers use an Applicant Tracking System. Names you may see on careers pages: **Workday, Greenhouse, Lever, iCIMS, Taleo, SmartRecruiters, BambooHR.**

What it does with your CV

1. **Reads:** turns your file into plain text.
2. **Sorts:** splits the text into fields: name, contact, job titles, employers, dates, skills, education.
3. **Searches:** lets recruiters type keywords like "Excel", "marketing intern" or "IELTS" to find people.
4. **Ranks:** many systems score how closely your CV matches the job post.

IN PLAIN WORDS

Think of the ATS as a **very fast, very literal librarian**. It doesn't care how pretty your CV looks. It only files what it can read. Anything it can't read becomes invisible.

TIP

How to tell you're using an ATS: you upload your CV and the website **auto-fills a form** with your details. Whatever it gets wrong there, it also got wrong in its database.

ATS Myths You Can Stop Worrying About

The internet is full of scary ATS claims. Here's the reality.

✕ "The ATS automatically rejects most CVs."

✓ Mostly it **ranks** and filters. People make most decisions. But a CV it can't read will rank at the bottom.

✕ "One missing keyword = instant rejection."

✓ Rarely. Some forms do have **"knockout questions"** (e.g. "Do you have the right to work here?"). Answer them honestly.

✕ "Hide keywords in white text to trick it."

✓ It gets detected, and recruiters treat it as cheating.

✕ "A colourful, creative template shows personality."

✓ Columns, icons and graphics often scramble the text. Show creativity in your portfolio instead.

✕ "I must pay for an 'ATS-optimised' template."

✓ A plain Word or Google Docs file that follows this book is enough.

DO THIS

Clear, simple, honest and relevant CVs win with **both** the robot and the human.

The 7-Second Scan

An eye-tracking study by the job site Ladders found recruiters spend about **7 seconds** on a first look at a CV. They don't read it. They scan it.



Where their eyes go first

1. Your name and target job title
2. Your degree or latest role
3. Job titles and organisation names
4. Dates
5. Words that match the job
6. Numbers that stand out

DO THIS

Put your **strongest, most relevant** information in the **top third** of the page.

IN PLAIN WORDS

A **"scannable"** CV has clear headings, short bullet points, bold job titles, white space between sections and no long paragraphs.

WHAT MAKES RECRUITERS STOP READING

Spelling mistakes · walls of text · no job title at the top · unexplained abbreviations · an unprofessional email address · a CV that clearly wasn't written for *this* job.

Job Ads Are Wish Lists

Many graduates don't apply because they don't match every line of a job ad. That's a mistake.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

A job description describes an **ideal** candidate who rarely exists. Hiring managers expect you to meet the core must-haves, not every single item.

Rules of thumb

- ✓ You match about **60–70%**, including the core skills? **Apply.**
- ✓ "1–2 years' experience" on a junior role? Internships, projects, part-time work and leadership often count. **Apply.**
- ✓ "Preferred", "a plus", "nice to have" means **optional**.
- ✗ Legal must-haves are real: a professional licence, a work permit, or a specific degree for regulated jobs (medicine, law, engineering).

Read a job post with three highlighters

Must-haves | Nice-to-haves | Culture clues

Culture clues like *"fast-paced"*, *"detail-oriented"* and *"collaborative"* tell you which stories to put in your CV and tell in interviews.

TIP

Collect 5–10 similar job posts. The words that keep repeating are **your industry's vocabulary**. Use them.

Step 1: Start With a Master CV

Before you write a neat one-page CV, write a long, messy one. This is your private "everything file". Nobody else will see it.

Brain-dump everything from your university years

- Degree, CGPA, awards, scholarships
- Thesis or capstone project
- Internships, part-time jobs
- Freelance gigs, tutoring
- Clubs, societies, roles held
- Events you organised
- Course, personal & hackathon projects
- Competitions and results
- Volunteering, community work
- Certificates and online courses
- Tools and software you've used
- Languages and test scores

For each item, answer four questions

1. **What did I do?** Use verbs: organised, wrote, built, sold, analysed.
2. **How?** Which tools, methods or skills did I use?
3. **For whom?** Customers, students, a team, a client?
4. **What changed?** Numbers, results, feedback, awards.

IN PLAIN WORDS

You never send the master CV. For each job, you **copy the most relevant parts** into a clean one-page CV.

TIP

Keep it in Google Docs and add to it every month. You'll forget the details faster than you think.

Anatomy of a Fresher CV

For graduates with little work experience, this section order works in almost every field.

1	**Header**	Name, target title, contact, links
2	**Summary**	Your 2–3 line pitch
3	**Skills**	Tools, methods, languages
4	**Education**	Degree, CGPA, honours, coursework
5	**Experience**	Internships, part-time, freelance
6	**Projects**	Academic, personal, competitions
7	**Leadership & Volunteering**	Clubs, events, community
8	**Certifications & Awards**	Optional, if relevant

- **Experience or Projects first?** Whichever is stronger and more relevant to the job goes higher.
- **Length:** one page. Two pages only if you have substantial research, publications or several internships.

IN PLAIN WORDS

"Fresher" means a recent graduate with little or no full-time experience. After 1–2 years of work, Experience moves *above* Education.

TIP

See the full example on p. 35.

The ATS-Safe Layout: Do This

Design for the robot first. The good news is that what's easy for the robot to read is also easy for tired human eyes.

RULE	WHY
One column, top to bottom	The ATS reads left to right, top to bottom.
Standard font	Calibri, Arial, Helvetica, Georgia, Garamond or Times New Roman read cleanly everywhere.
Clear sizes	Name 16–20 pt · headings 12–14 pt · body 10–11 pt.
Standard headings	Summary, Skills, Education, Experience, Projects. The ATS knows these words.
Simple bullets	Use • or –, with one idea per bullet.
One date format	e.g. *Jun 2024 – Aug 2024* everywhere.
Margins 1.3–2.5 cm	White space makes it easier to scan.
Bold sparingly	Use it for job titles and degrees, not random words.
Black on white	It prints, photocopies and displays well on any screen.

TIP

Open a **blank** Word or Google Docs file. You don't need a fancy template, just a clean structure. A ready-to-copy skeleton is on p. 60.

… and Avoid This

These are the most common reasons a CV gets scrambled or skipped.

AVOID	BECAUSE
Tables, text boxes, two-column layouts	Text is read in the wrong order or skipped.
Photos, icons, logos, graphics	Unreadable to software, and they invite bias.
Skill bars, stars, "Python 80%"	Meaningless. 80% of what?
Contact info in the page header/footer	Many systems ignore those areas.
Creative headings ("My Journey")	The ATS can't tell which section it is.
Fancy bullets (★ ➤ ✓)	They can turn into garbled symbols.
Designs exported as images	To software, a picture of text has no text in it.
Tiny fonts to fit more in	Hard to read. Cut content instead.

AVOID

Beautiful CV templates from social media and design apps often **fail** in an ATS. Save your design skills for your portfolio.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Designers and other creatives may send a styled CV **by email** to a person. For online application portals, always upload the plain version.

File Type, File Name & Email

The first impression starts before anyone opens your CV.

File type

✓ **PDF (text-based)** is the best default. In Word or Google Docs, use *Save as / Download → PDF*.

✓ **Word (.docx)** if the job post asks for it.

✗ Images (JPG/PNG), phone photos or scans of a printed CV.

10-SECOND TEST

Open your PDF and try to **highlight a word** with your cursor. If you can, it's text-based. If not, the ATS sees a blank page.

File name (recruiters see it)

✓ `Nadia-Rahman-CV.pdf` or `Nadia-Rahman-Data-Analyst-CV.pdf`

✗ `CV final final (2).pdf` · `resume_new.pdf` · `Document1.pdf`

Email address

✓ `nadia.rahman@gmail.com` (first name + last name)

✗ `cutie.nadia99@…` · your university email, which may stop working after graduation

Keep the file under 2 MB.

The Header: Who You Are & How to Reach You

Put it in the **main body** of the document, not in Word's page-header area.

1. **Full name:** the largest text on the page. No "CV" or "Résumé" title needed.
2. **Target job title:** copy the job post's wording, e.g. *Graduate Data Analyst*.
3. **Phone** with country code if applying abroad: *+880 17XX-XXXXXX*.
4. **Professional email.**
5. **City, Country.** For remote jobs, add your time zone: *Dhaka, Bangladesh (GMT+6)*.
6. **LinkedIn URL**, customised (see tip).
7. **Portfolio / GitHub / website**, but only if it's finished and live.

EXAMPLE

Nadia Rahman

Graduate Data Analyst

+880 17XX-XXXXXX · nadia.rahman@gmail.com · Dhaka, Bangladesh (GMT+6)
linkedin.com/in/nadia-rahman · github.com/nadiarahman

TIP

Customise your LinkedIn link: on your profile, open **Edit public profile & URL** and change the random numbers to your name.

Personal Details: What to Leave Out

Many graduates copy old CV formats full of personal information. Modern employers don't need it, and it can lead to unfair bias.

Leave these out unless the job post asks for them

- ✕ Photo
- ✕ Date of birth or age
- ✕ Gender, marital status
- ✕ Religion, caste, ethnicity
- ✕ Parents' names
- ✕ National ID or passport no.
- ✕ Full street address
- ✕ Height, weight, blood group
- ✕ "Career Objective: To work in a challenging environment..."
- ✕ "I hereby declare..." + signature
- ✕ "References available upon request"

IN PLAIN WORDS

Why drop "References available upon request"? Employers already assume it. Use that line for a skill or an achievement instead.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Some countries, government jobs and local employers still expect a photo or personal details. **Follow the job post.** When it says nothing, leave them out, which is the global standard.

The Summary: Your 3-Line Pitch

The Summary sits right under your header and answers three questions: **Who are you? What can you do? What do you want?**

IN PLAIN WORDS

It replaces the old *"Career Objective"*. An objective talks about what **you want**. A summary talks about what **you offer**, and that's what employers care about.

FORMULA

[Degree] graduate with **[2–3 key skills from the job post]**, shown through **[your best internship or project + one result]**. Seeking a **[exact job title]** role in **[type of team or industry]**.

Rules

- ✓ 2–4 lines. No more.
- ✓ Include 2–3 keywords from the job post.
- ✓ Include **one number** (people, %, time, money).
- ✓ Change the last sentence for every job.
- ✓ Skip "I" and "my". Write *"Finance graduate with…"*, not *"I am a finance graduate…"*

Summary Examples

Notice how each one names skills, gives proof and states a target.

BUSINESS

Finance graduate (BBA, CGPA 3.7/4.0) with hands-on financial modelling, Excel and Power BI experience from a 3-month fintech internship, where an automated weekly report saved the team 6 hours a week. Seeking a Graduate Financial Analyst role.

TECHNOLOGY

Computer Science graduate skilled in Python, SQL and REST APIs. Built and deployed 3 full-stack projects, including a course-registration tool used by 200+ students. Seeking a Junior Backend Developer role.

ARTS & COMMUNICATION

English Literature graduate with strong writing, editing and social media skills. Published 40+ articles in the university magazine and tripled its Instagram audience in one year. Seeking a Content Writer or Communications Assistant role.

✕ "Hard-working, passionate and dynamic team player seeking a challenging role to grow my skills."

Why it fails: thousands of graduates write this exact sentence. It has no skills, no proof and no target job. *Show* that you're hard-working with a result instead of claiming it.

The Skills Section: Where Keywords Live

This is the section the ATS searches most and the recruiter checks first. Use labelled groups in plain text.

EXAMPLE

Technical: Python, SQL, Excel (PivotTables, XLOOKUP), Power BI, Google Analytics

Methods: Data cleaning, A/B testing, Dashboard design, Agile/Scrum

Languages: English (IELTS 7.5), Bangla (Native), Hindi (Conversational)

Certifications: Google Data Analytics Certificate (2025)

DO THIS

- Use the job post's **exact words**: "Microsoft Excel", not "spreadsheets".
- Write both forms once: *Search Engine Optimization (SEO)*.
- Put the job's top 3 skills first.
- Aim for 10–15 skills.

AVOID

- Skill bars, % or star ratings.
- Soft skills ("teamwork"). Prove them in bullets.
- Basics like MS Word, email, internet.
- Anything you can't discuss in an interview.

IN PLAIN WORDS

Language levels, from strongest: **Native → Fluent → Professional → Conversational → Basic.** A test score (IELTS, TOEFL, CEFR C1) is even clearer.

Education: Lead With It (For Now)

As a fresh graduate, your degree is your strongest credential, so place Education **above** Experience.

What to include

- **Full degree name:** *Bachelor of Science in Computer Science*, not just "BSc CSE".
- **University, city, country** and **graduation month/year** (or *Expected Jun 2026*).
- **CGPA** if it's strong (about 3.3/4.0 or above), always with the scale: *3.72/4.00*.
- **Honours:** Dean's List, scholarships, awards.
- **Relevant coursework:** 4–6 courses that match the job.
- **Thesis / capstone** with a one-line result.

EXAMPLE

Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA), Marketing Jun 2025
Eastbridge University, Dhaka, Bangladesh · CGPA 3.68/4.00 · Dean's List (4 semesters)

Relevant coursework: Digital Marketing, Consumer Behaviour, Marketing Analytics, Brand Management

AVOID

School-level results (unless the employer asks or you have nothing else), a weak CGPA (just leave it out), and every course you ever took.

"But I Have No Experience!"

You probably have more than you think. "Experience" isn't only full-time jobs. All of these count:

Work

- Internships (paid or unpaid)
- Part-time jobs (any kind)
- Freelance gigs
- Tutoring
- Family business

Academic

- Capstone / thesis
- Research assistant
- Teaching assistant
- Course projects
- Competitions

Leadership

- Club or society roles
- Organising events
- Team captain
- Student government

Community

- Volunteering
- NGO work
- Campaigns
- Fundraising

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Employers value **any** job, even one unrelated to your degree. A shift at a café or shop shows reliability, punctuality, handling customers and working under pressure, which every workplace needs.

TIP

Use a heading that fits: **Experience**, **Relevant Experience**, or split into **Experience** + **Leadership & Volunteering**.

Writing an Experience Entry

Every entry uses the same skeleton. Consistency makes you look organised.

```
Job Title — Organisation, City (or Remote)     Mon YYYY – Mon YYYY
• Most relevant achievement for THIS job
• Second achievement
• Third (optional)
```

Marketing Intern — BrightCart, Dhaka Jun – Aug 2024

- Planned 12 Instagram campaigns reaching 450K users; raised engagement from 2.1% to 3.8%.

Freelance Graphic Designer — Self-employed (Fiverr), Remote 2023 – 2024

- Delivered 60+ logo and social media projects for 35 clients; 4.9/5 average rating.

Tricky situations

Unpaid or short internship	It still counts. List it normally.
Family business	Give your real role: *Sales Assistant, Rahman Traders (family business)*. Be honest, because they may check.
Still doing it	Use *Mar 2025 – Present*.

Bullets That Prove Impact

This page matters most. Weak bullets describe **duties**. Strong bullets prove **results**.

GOOGLE'S XYZ FORMULA

Accomplished [X], as measured by [Y], by doing [Z].

In other words: what you achieved + the number + how you did it.

✗ Responsible for social media.

✓ Grew the club's Instagram from 400 to 2,300 followers in 6 months by posting weekly reels and running two campus contests.

✗ Worked on a machine learning project.

✓ Built a sentiment-analysis model (Python, scikit-learn) with 89% accuracy on 10,000 reviews; deployed it as a web app.

✗ Helped customers at the shop.

✓ Served 40+ customers a day and handled cash and returns accurately throughout a 6-month part-time role.

Five rules

1. Start with a **strong past-tense verb** (see next page).
2. **Add a number** wherever you honestly can.
3. **Name the tools and methods**. These are keywords.
4. Keep each bullet to **1–2 lines**.
5. No "I", "my" or "we".

Action Verb Bank

Start every bullet with one of these. Don't use the same verb more than twice on one CV.

Leading	Led, Coordinated, Organised, Managed, Mentored, Directed, Chaired
Creating	Built, Designed, Developed, Launched, Wrote, Produced, Created
Improving	Increased, Reduced, Improved, Streamlined, Automated, Saved, Simplified
Analysing	Analysed, Researched, Evaluated, Measured, Forecast, Tested, Identified
Communicating	Presented, Negotiated, Persuaded, Trained, Pitched, Edited, Published
Serving	Resolved, Advised, Served, Onboarded, Guided, Tutored, Supported
Winning	Won, Achieved, Earned, Secured, Exceeded, Ranked, Awarded

Weak openers to replace

✕ Responsible for · Helped with · Worked on · Assisted in · Was part of · Participated in · Handled

TIP

Ask yourself: *"What did **I** actually do?"* "Helped with the event" might really be "**Booked** 4 speakers" or "**Designed** all event posters".

IN PLAIN WORDS

Use **past tense** for finished roles (*built*) and **present tense** for current ones (*build*).

"I Don't Have Any Numbers!"

You do. Ask yourself these questions about each experience:

How many?	People, customers, events, posts, products, students
How much?	Money raised, budget managed, sales made
How often?	Daily, weekly, per semester
How fast?	Time saved, deadline met, turnaround
How big?	Audience, reach, followers, attendees
How well?	Rating, rank, grade, accuracy, award
Before → after?	% growth, % reduction, improvement

✕ Tutored school students.

✓ Tutored 6 students in Maths for 2 years; 5 improved their exam grade by at least one level.

HONEST ESTIMATES ARE FINE

Use "about" or "~" when unsure: *"~200 attendees"*. **Never invent numbers.** Interviewers will ask how you measured them.

TIP

No number at all? Show **scope** instead: *"for a 5-person team"*, *"across 3 departments"*, *"within a 2-week deadline"*.

The Projects Section

For many graduates, projects are the strongest proof of skill. Give them their own section if you have 2 or more good ones.

Format

```
Project Name — tools used · link            Mon YYYY
• What it does, for whom, and the measurable result
```

EXAMPLES

Campus Food-Waste Tracker — Flask, PostgreSQL · github.com/you/foodtrack
• Built a web app used by 3 cafeterias to log daily waste; reported waste fell 18% in one semester.

Go-to-Market Plan for a Skincare Brand — Capstone
• Surveyed 220 customers and built a launch plan with budget and KPIs; the client adopted the pricing strategy.

Project ideas by field

Business	Market research, business plan, financial model, case competition
Tech / data	App, website, dashboard, data analysis, automation script
Creative	Brand identity, campaign, video series, publication
Science / social	Research paper, survey study, lab project, policy brief

TIP

A project done for a **real person** (a shop, club or NGO) beats a copy of a tutorial.

Keywords: Read the Job Post Like a Recruiter

Keywords are the words the ATS searches for and the recruiter expects to see. They come from the job post itself.

SAMPLE JOB POST · JUNIOR MARKETING ASSOCIATE

We're a fast-paced e-commerce startup looking for a Junior Marketing Associate to support our growth team.

Requirements: Bachelor's degree in Marketing or related field · Experience with social media marketing and Meta Ads Manager · Strong Excel or Google Sheets skills · Detail-oriented with excellent written English

Nice to have: Google Analytics · SEO basics · Canva · email marketing

Must-have keywords Bonus keywords Culture clues

How to spot them

- **Tools and software:** Meta Ads Manager, Excel, Canva
- **Skills and methods:** social media marketing, SEO
- **Words that repeat** or appear under "Requirements"
- **The exact job title**, which you'll copy into your header

TIP

Read 3–5 similar job posts. The words that keep coming up are the keywords for that whole role, not just one company.

Keywords: Where to Put Them (Honestly)

Spread keywords naturally across your CV. Both the ATS and the human should find them.

WHERE	EXAMPLE
Target title	*Junior Marketing Associate*
Summary	"...experience in **social media marketing** and **Meta Ads Manager**..."
Skills	Exact tool names, in the job's own wording
Bullets	"Ran 12 campaigns in **Meta Ads Manager**; tracked results in **Google Sheets**."

- ✓ Write both forms once: *Search Engine Optimization (SEO)*.
- ✓ Match the job's spelling (US *analyze* vs. UK *analyse*).
- ✓ Aim to naturally include most must-have keywords that are **true for you**.

AVOID

- A paragraph that just lists keywords ("keyword stuffing")
- Hidden white text
- Claiming tools you've never used. One interview question will expose it.

TIP

Missing a must-have skill? A short free course and a small project can close the gap in a weekend. Then it's honestly yours.

Tailoring in 15 Minutes

One generic CV sent to 200 jobs usually loses to a tailored CV sent to 20. Here's a repeatable routine.

MINUTES	DO THIS
0–3	**Read and highlight** the job post: must-haves, tools and the exact job title.
3–6	**Header and Summary:** match the job title; add 2–3 of its keywords; rewrite the last sentence.
6–10	**Skills and bullets:** move their top skills first; put the most relevant bullet first under each role.
10–13	**Trim** anything irrelevant so it fits on one page. Your master CV keeps everything.
13–15	**Export and check:** save as `Name-Role-CV.pdf`, test that the text highlights, and log it in your tracker (p. 61).

TIP

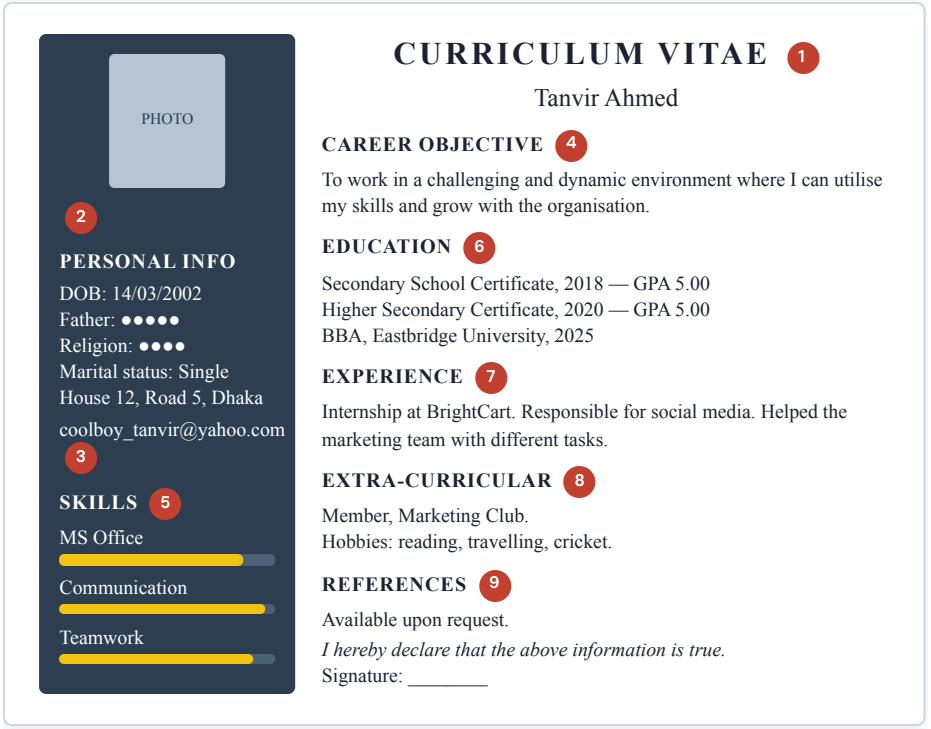
Keep 2–4 **base versions** for the job types you target (e.g. "Marketing", "Sales", "Operations"). Then tailoring means editing, not rewriting.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Recruiters can tell a mass-sent CV from a tailored one. Tailoring shows **genuine interest**, which is one of the main things they look for in graduates.

Before: A Typical Graduate CV

Meet Tanvir, a marketing graduate. This is the CV he sent to 40 companies with no replies. Can you spot the problems?



1. "Curriculum Vitae" title wastes the top spot
2. Photo & personal details invite bias
3. Unprofessional email
4. Generic objective: no skills, no target
5. Skill bars in a two-column layout scramble in an ATS
6. School results; degree has no details
7. Duties, not results: no tools, no numbers
8. "Member" & generic hobbies prove nothing
9. References & declaration are unnecessary
10. Missing: job title, LinkedIn, his freelance work and capstone

After: Same Graduate, Rewritten

Same person, same history. Nothing new was added except clarity. Now it works for both the robot and the human.

TANVIR AHMED

Digital Marketing Associate 1

+880 17XX-XXXXXX · tanvir.ahmed@gmail.com · Dhaka, Bangladesh (GMT+6) · linkedin.com/in/tanvir-ahmed · tanvirahmed.notion.site

SUMMARY 2

Marketing graduate (BBA, CGPA 3.62/4.00) with hands-on experience in social media marketing, Meta Ads Manager and Google Analytics. During a 3-month internship, planned 12 campaigns that lifted engagement from 2.1% to 3.8%. Seeking a Digital Marketing Associate role in a growth-focused team.

SKILLS 3

Marketing: Social media marketing, Meta Ads Manager, Search Engine Optimization (SEO), Content strategy, Email marketing
Tools: Google Analytics 4, Canva, Mailchimp, Excel (PivotTables), Google Sheets
Languages: English (IELTS 7.5), Bangla (Native) · **Certification:** Google Digital Marketing & E-commerce (2025)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA), Marketing — Eastbridge University, Dhaka Jun 2025
CGPA 3.62/4.00 · Dean's List (3 semesters) · Coursework: Digital Marketing, Consumer Behaviour, Marketing Analytics

EXPERIENCE 4

Marketing Intern — BrightCart (e-commerce startup), Dhaka Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Planned and ran 12 Instagram and Facebook campaigns reaching 450K users; raised average engagement from 2.1% to 3.8%.
- Built a weekly performance report in Google Sheets, cutting reporting time from 3 hours to 45 minutes.
- Wrote 30+ product captions and 4 Mailchimp newsletters with a 28% average open rate.

Freelance Social Media Manager — Self-employed, Remote Jan 2023 – May 2024

- Managed Instagram for 3 local businesses; grew a café's followers from 800 to 4,200 in 8 months.

PROJECTS 5

Capstone: Go-to-Market Plan for a Skincare Brand Jan – Apr 2025

- Surveyed 220 customers and built a launch plan with budget and KPIs; the client adopted the pricing strategy.

LEADERSHIP

Event Lead — University Marketing Club Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

- Led a 9-member team to run a 300-attendee career fair; secured BDT 250,000 in sponsorships.

Why the New Version Works

Nothing was invented. Tanvir simply **showed** what he had already done.

1. **A target job title** under his name tells the recruiter in one second what he's applying for. It matches the job post word for word.
2. **The summary** combines his degree, three keywords, one proof with numbers and a clear goal.
3. **Grouped skills** in plain text, using the job post's exact tool names, so the ATS can find them.
4. **Result-based bullets:** verb + action + tool + number. "Responsible for social media" became three achievements.
5. **Hidden experience revealed.** His freelance work and capstone were always there. He just hadn't thought they "counted".

What he removed

Photo, personal details, objective, skill bars, school results, hobbies, references, declaration. That freed up the space for proof.

DO THIS

Single column · standard headings · one font · consistent dates · one page · text-based PDF named `Tanvir-Ahmed-Digital-Marketing-CV.pdf`.

TIP

Use this CV as your model. The blank template is on p. 60.

12 Mistakes Recruiters See Every Day

Avoiding these puts you ahead of most applicants.

1. **Typos and grammar errors.** To many recruiters, these signal carelessness.
2. **The wrong company name** in your summary or cover letter after copy-pasting.
3. **One generic CV** sent to every job.
4. **Duties instead of results** ("Responsible for…").
5. **Walls of text:** long paragraphs nobody reads.
6. **Fancy templates** that the ATS can't read.
7. **Inconsistent dates and formatting** (Jan 2024, 03/24, March '24).
8. **Missing or broken links**, or a portfolio that isn't finished.
9. **Lies or exaggeration.** Facts get checked, and the truth comes out in interviews.
10. **Too long:** three pages for a fresh graduate.
11. **An unprofessional email address** or voicemail greeting.
12. **A CV that doesn't match LinkedIn:** different titles or dates raise red flags.

TIP

Read your CV **out loud**, slowly. Your ear catches mistakes your eyes skip.

Final Checklist (1/2): Format

Check every line before you hit "Submit".

Layout

- [ ] Single column; no tables, text boxes or sidebars
- [ ] Standard font, 10–11 pt body text
- [ ] No photo, icons, graphics or skill bars
- [ ] Contact details in the main body, not the page header/footer
- [ ] Standard section headings
- [ ] The same date format on every entry
- [ ] Fits on one page with comfortable margins

File

- [ ] Text-based PDF (you can highlight the words), or .docx if asked
- [ ] Named `Firstname-Lastname-Role-CV.pdf`
- [ ] Under 2 MB

Consistency

- [ ] Name, job titles and dates match your LinkedIn
- [ ] Every link opens the right page (test them!)
- [ ] Professional email address and working phone number

Final Checklist (2/2): Content

Top third

- [ ] Target job title matches the job post
- [ ] Summary includes 2–3 keywords and one number
- [ ] No "Career Objective"

Body

- [ ] Skills use the job's exact wording (and both forms of acronyms)
- [ ] Every bullet starts with an action verb
- [ ] Most bullets contain a number or a clear scope
- [ ] Tools and methods are named inside the bullets
- [ ] No "Responsible for", "Helped with" or "hard-working team player"
- [ ] Most relevant experience and bullets come first

Truth & polish

- [ ] Every line is true, and I can talk about it for 2 minutes
- [ ] Spell-checked, read aloud, and checked by one other person
- [ ] The right company and job title (if they appear anywhere)

DO THIS

All boxes ticked? **Send it.** Don't polish forever. A good CV sent today beats a perfect CV sent next month.

Test Your CV Like a Recruiter

Don't guess whether your CV works. Test it once for each base version.

1 · The copy-paste test (robot view)

Open your PDF, select all, copy, and paste into Notepad or TextEdit. Is the order logical? Are dates next to the right jobs? Did anything vanish? If it's scrambled there, it's scrambled in the ATS.

2 · The free scanner test

Upload your CV and a job post to a free ATS checker (e.g. Jobscan, Resume Worded, Teal). Look for missing keywords and parsing errors. Ignore any advice to add skills you don't have.

3 · The 7-second test (human view)

Show your CV to a friend for 7 seconds, then take it away. Ask: *"What job am I applying for? What's my strongest skill? Which number do you remember?"*

4 · The auto-fill test

Upload to a real careers page (many use Workday or Greenhouse) and watch the form fill itself. Every wrong field points to a formatting fix.

5 · The phone test

Open the PDF on your phone. Many recruiters read CVs on mobile. Is it still readable?

Getting (and Giving) Feedback

A second pair of eyes catches what you can't see. But *how* you ask matters.

Who to ask

- A senior or alumnus working in your **target field** (best)
- Your university career centre
- An internship supervisor or a professor
- Recruiters at career fairs, who often give quick feedback on the spot

How to ask

> *"Could you spend 10 minutes on my CV? I'm applying for roles like this one [link]. Two questions: Is it clear what job I'm aiming for? Which section is weakest?"*

Specific questions get useful answers. "Any thoughts?" gets "Looks good!"

Handling feedback

- Say thank you, and don't argue or explain.
- If **two or more people** say the same thing, fix it.
- If advice conflicts, follow the job post and the ATS rules in this book.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Reviewing a friend's CV? Give the **3 most important fixes**, not 30 small ones. Start with something they did well. Use the scorecard on the next page.

The CV Scorecard

Use it on your own CV or when reviewing someone else's. Score each line: **0** = missing · **1** = partly · **2** = strong.

CRITERIA	WHAT "2" LOOKS LIKE	SCORE
ATS-readable	Single column, plain text, standard headings, text-based PDF	__ /2
Clear target	Title and summary match one specific job	__ /2
Keywords	Most must-have keywords appear naturally	__ /2
Impact	Verb-led bullets with numbers and tools	__ /2
Proof	Projects, links or portfolio back up the claims	__ /2
Scannable	Strong top third, white space, one page	__ /2
Polished	No typos; consistent dates and format	__ /2
Honest	Every line can be explained in an interview	__ /2
	Total	**__ /16**

13–16	Ready. Send it and focus on networking.
9–12	Fix the lowest-scoring rows first.
0–8	Rebuild it with the template on p. 60.

Where to Find Openings

A great CV is useless if it never reaches the right inbox. Use several sources at once, not just one job site.

SOURCE	GOOD FOR
Job sites: bdjobs.com, LinkedIn Jobs	Most private-sector openings. Save searches and turn on **job alerts** for 2–3 job titles.
Company career pages	Banks, telecoms, FMCG and multinationals. Many post only on their own site.
Government jobs	BCS and other circulars on **bpsc.gov.bd** and official ministry sites. Apply only through the link in the official circular.
NGOs & development	Each organisation's own careers page.
University career office & alumni	Campus recruitment, job fairs and internships meant for graduates like you.
People	Seniors, teachers and LinkedIn connections. Many roles are filled through referrals (p. 54).

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Many large employers hire fresh graduates in batches through **Management Trainee** (MT/MTO) programmes, often once a year. Note the months they usually open and prepare early.

SPOT A FAKE JOB POST

- Asks you to pay for "registration", "training" or "processing"
- Salary far above normal for no experience
- Contact only by WhatsApp or Telegram; no website, no office address
- Asks for your NID, bank details or a bKash/Nagad PIN or OTP early on
- Pressure: "Join today, only 3 seats left!"

THE RULE

A real employer never asks you to pay to get a job. Never share a PIN or OTP with anyone.

Cover Letters: Do You Need One?

A cover letter is a short letter explaining **why this job** and **why you**. Your CV shows what you've done. The letter connects it to their needs.

When to send one

- ✓ The application asks for it, even if it says "optional". Optional is a free chance to stand out.
- ✓ You're changing fields, or need to explain something (relocating, a gap).
- ✓ When emailing your CV, the email body acts as a short cover letter (p. 47).

The 4-paragraph structure

1. **Hook:** the role, where you saw it and who you are in one line.
2. **Proof:** 1–2 achievements that match their top requirements.
3. **Fit:** why *this* company. Mention something specific: a product, its mission, recent news.
4. **Close:** thank them and say you'd welcome an interview.

AVOID

- Repeating your CV word for word
- "To Whom It May Concern" (use the person's name, or "Dear Hiring Team")
- Apologising: "Although I don't have much experience..."
- More than one page. Aim for 200–300 words.

Cover Letter Example

Tanvir applying to the job post from p. 31. Notice the four parts.

Dear Ms Karim,

[Hook] I'm excited to apply for the Junior Marketing Associate role at ShopNest, which I found on LinkedIn. I recently graduated in Marketing from Eastbridge University and have spent the past two years running social media campaigns for a startup and for local businesses.

[Proof] During my internship at BrightCart, I planned 12 campaigns in Meta Ads Manager that reached 450,000 users and raised average engagement from 2.1% to 3.8%. I also built a Google Sheets report that cut weekly reporting from three hours to 45 minutes, a small change that let the team act on results faster.

[Fit] I've followed ShopNest since your "local makers" campaign last spring. Your focus on small brands is exactly the kind of growth marketing I want to build my career in, and I'd love to bring the same test-and-learn approach to your team.

[Close] Thank you for considering my application. I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I can contribute.

Kind regards,
Tanvir Ahmed

TIP

Write the letter fresh for each company, but reuse your strongest **Proof** paragraph and adjust it to each job post's keywords.

Online Application Forms

Many graduates rush the form after perfecting the CV. Recruiters often see the form **first**.

Auto-filled fields	Check every one. Parsers mix up titles, dates and employers. Fix them by hand.
"Are you authorised to work in…?"	These are **knockout questions** that can screen you out automatically. Answer honestly.
Expected salary	Research first (LinkedIn Salary, Glassdoor, seniors in the field). Give a realistic range, or "Negotiable" if allowed.
Start date / notice period	"Immediately" or the exact date you're free.
"How did you hear about us?"	If someone referred you, name them here.
Optional diversity questions	Voluntary. Answering or skipping won't affect your application.
Upload	Double-check that you've attached the **right version** of your CV.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Talking about salary is **normal and expected** in professional life, not rude or greedy. Knowing the market rate protects you from accepting far too little.

TIP

Save a copy of every job post (PDF or screenshot). Posts disappear after closing, and you'll need them to prepare for interviews.

Emailing Your CV

Some jobs say "send your CV to hr@...". Your email is the first thing they read, so treat it like a mini cover letter.

Subject: Application – Junior Marketing Associate – Tanvir Ahmed

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm writing to apply for the Junior Marketing Associate role advertised on LinkedIn. I recently graduated in Marketing from Eastbridge University and completed a 3-month marketing internship at BrightCart, where my campaigns raised engagement from 2.1% to 3.8%.

I've attached my CV and cover letter. You can see samples of my work at tanvirahmed.notion.site.

Thank you for your time. I'd welcome the chance to discuss the role.

Best regards,
Tanvir Ahmed
+880 17XX-XXXXXX · linkedin.com/in/tanvir-ahmed

DO THIS

- Clear subject line with the job title
- PDF attached and named properly
- Send from your professional email
- Send a test email to yourself first

AVOID

- Empty email with just an attachment
- "Pls find attached"
- Emojis or casual language
- CCing many companies at once

After You Apply: Follow-Up, Silence & Rejection

What happens next is a big part of professional culture that nobody teaches.

Follow up once, politely

No reply after **7–10 working days**? Send one short note to the recruiter or hiring contact:

> *"Hi [Name], I applied for the [Role] position on [date] and remain very interested. I'd be grateful for any update on the timeline. Thank you!"*

Silence ("ghosting")

It happens a lot, and it's almost never personal. Recruiters handle hundreds of applicants. Keep applying elsewhere. **Never wait on one job.**

Rejection

Reply graciously. Companies remember it, and roles reopen:

> *"Thank you for letting me know. I enjoyed learning about [Company] and would be glad to be considered for future roles."*

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

It's normal for graduates to apply to **many** roles before landing an interview. Rejection is part of the process, not a judgement of your worth. Treat each one as data: which versions get replies?

LinkedIn: Your Searchable CV

Recruiters search LinkedIn the same way they search an ATS: by keywords. A strong profile gets you found **before** you apply, and checked **after** you do.

Photo	Clear, friendly, plain background, your face filling most of the frame. Profiles with photos get many more views.
Headline	Not "Student at X". Try: *Marketing Graduate | Social Media · Meta Ads · Google Analytics | Seeking Digital Marketing Roles*
About	Your CV summary expanded to 4–6 short lines, in the first person ("I…"). End with what you're looking for.
Experience & Projects	Same titles and dates as your CV. Add links, PDFs and screenshots.
Skills	Add your real skills and choose up to 5 **Top skills** to show in your About section.
Featured	Pin your best project, portfolio link or video introduction.
Custom URL	`linkedin.com/in/firstname-lastname`
Open to Work	Turn it on and choose your target job titles. You can make it visible to recruiters only.

IN PLAIN WORDS

On LinkedIn, writing in the first person is normal ("I build dashboards…"). On your CV, leave out "I".

LinkedIn: Be Visible (Even If You Think You Have Nothing to Say)

You don't need to be an expert to post. Sharing what you're **learning** is enough.

Easy post ideas

- **A project breakdown:** the problem, what you did, one thing you learned
- **A new certificate,** plus the most useful idea from the course
- **Takeaways** from an event, webinar or book
- **A thank-you** to a mentor, team or internship supervisor
- **A thoughtful question** to professionals in your target field

> SIMPLE POST FORMULA
> Short hook line → 3–6 short lines of story or lesson → an image or screenshot → a question to invite comments.

Comment & connect

- Comment with a real thought or question. "Great post!" adds nothing.
- Add a short personal note to connection requests: who you are and why you're connecting.
- Ask a professor or internship manager for a **recommendation**.

> WORK-CULTURE NOTE
> Treat LinkedIn as part of your CV. Recruiters read your activity, so avoid arguments, political fights and memes.

Portfolio: Show, Don't Just Tell

More employers now hire on skills, not just degrees. A CV **claims** you have skills. A portfolio **proves** it.

Choose a platform for your field

Tech & data	GitHub (with clear README files and a demo link), Kaggle, a simple personal website
Design & creative	Behance, Dribbble, or a personal website with case studies
Marketing, business, writing	A Notion page or one-page website with campaigns, decks and writing samples; Medium articles
Research & science	Google Scholar, ResearchGate, a page summarising your thesis
Everyone	LinkedIn's **Featured** section and Projects

- ✓ **3–5 strong projects** beat 20 weak ones.
- ✓ One link on your CV and LinkedIn that opens everything.
- ✓ Works on mobile and loads fast.

IN PLAIN WORDS

A free **Notion** or **Google Sites** page is a perfectly good portfolio. You don't need to code or pay for a website.

Turn a Project Into a Case Study

Don't just upload files. Tell the **story** behind each project. That's what hiring managers want to read.

1. **Problem:** what needed solving, and for whom?
2. **Your role:** what did *you* do, especially in a team?
3. **Process & tools:** the steps you took and the tools you used (more keywords!).
4. **Result:** numbers, feedback, screenshots, a live demo.
5. **Reflection:** what you learned and what you'd do differently.

MINI EXAMPLE

Campus Food-Waste Tracker

Problem: Cafeterias had no record of what food they wasted. **Role:** Solo developer. **Tools:** Flask, PostgreSQL, Chart.js. **Result:** 3 cafeterias used it daily; reported waste fell 18% in one semester. **Learned:** interviewing users first saved weeks of building the wrong features.

TIP

The **Reflection** step is what most graduates skip, and it's what makes you sound like someone who will grow on the job.

The Video Introduction

A short video lets employers **hear you communicate**, which no PDF can do. It turns "another applicant" into "a person I remember".

When to use it

- When a job asks for it, or values communication (sales, marketing, teaching, customer success, consulting)
- On your LinkedIn Featured section or portfolio homepage
- As a **link** (YouTube "unlisted", Loom, or Google Drive set to "anyone with the link") in an email

A 60–90 second script

10 sec	**Hello:** your name, degree and the role you're aiming for
40 sec	**Story:** one project or internship: the problem, what you did, the result
20 sec	**Why:** why this field or company excites you
10 sec	**Close:** thank them and point to your portfolio

DO THIS

- Phone at eye level, facing a window
- Quiet room, tidy background
- Bullet notes, not a script
- Add captions

AVOID

- Reading from a screen
- Filters or music
- Over 2 minutes
- Emailing large video files

Networking: Skip the Pile

Many jobs are filled through people, not portals. A **referral** puts your CV directly in front of a human, ahead of the ranking software.

IN PLAIN WORDS

Networking is not begging for jobs. It's asking people for advice and staying in touch. Most professionals are happy to help a polite graduate. Many were in your position not long ago.

Who to contact: build a list of 30

- **Alumni** from your university working in your target field (search LinkedIn by university)
- Former internship colleagues and supervisors
- Professors and their industry contacts
- Speakers and attendees from events you've joined
- Active posters in your field on LinkedIn

Where else to meet people

Career fairs, hackathons, meetups, webinars, professional associations (student membership is usually cheap), alumni groups, and online communities in your field.

TIP

Introverts often network better than they think. A thoughtful one-to-one message works better than working the room at an event.

Networking: What to Actually Say

1 · The first message (keep it short)

> *"Hi [Name], I'm a recent [degree] graduate from [university]. I enjoyed your post on [specific topic]. I'm exploring a career in [field] and would really value 15 minutes to hear how you got started. Happy to work around your schedule. Thank you!"*

Why it works: it's specific, polite, asks for **advice** (not a job) and is easy to say yes to.

2 · The conversation (an "informational interview")

- Prepare 3 questions: *"What does a typical day look like?" "Which skills matter most for juniors?" "What do you wish you'd known at my stage?"*
- Listen more than you talk. Keep to the time you asked for.
- Finish with: *"Is there anyone else you'd suggest I speak with?"*

3 · Within 24 hours

Send a thank-you message mentioning one thing you learned.

4 · When a job opens at their company

> *"I saw the [Role] opening at [Company]. Would you be comfortable referring me? I've attached my CV tailored to the role."*

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Give back too: share job posts, congratulate people, make introductions. Networking is a long-term habit, not a one-time favour.

Use AI Wisely, Not Lazily

Recruiters now see thousands of AI-written CVs full of words like *"spearheaded"*, *"leveraged"* and *"dynamic synergies"*. They're easy to spot and easy to forget.

IN PLAIN WORDS

Use AI as an **editor and coach**, not as the **author**. The facts and the voice must be yours.

GOOD USES

- Pull keywords from a job post
- Suggest stronger verbs for *your* bullets
- Find gaps between your CV and a job
- Check grammar and consistency
- Practise interview questions

BAD USES

- Writing a whole CV from nothing
- Inventing numbers or skills
- Copy-pasting the same cover letter
- Pasting output without reading it
- Words you'd never say out loud

Keep your voice

- Replace inflated words with plain ones: *led, built, wrote, sold, analysed*.
- Add details only you would know: a client's name, the exact number.
- If you wouldn't say it in an interview, delete it.

TIP

Knowing how to use AI tools is now a skill employers want. Mention it in your skills, backed by a project.

AI Prompts You Can Copy

Paste these into any AI assistant. Replace the [brackets]. **Never share your phone number, address or ID numbers** with AI tools.

Decode a job post

> Here is a job post: [paste]. List the top 10 hard skills and tools, the 5 main responsibilities, and any culture clues. Mark which are required vs. preferred.

Improve a bullet (without inventing)

> Rewrite this CV bullet using the formula "action verb + what + how + result". Use only the facts I give you and don't add numbers. Give 3 options. Facts: [what you did, tools, result].

Find the gaps

> Compare my CV [paste] with this job post [paste]. Which required keywords are missing? Which of my experiences could honestly show them?

Review like a recruiter

> Act as a recruiter hiring a [role]. Give me 5 seconds of first impressions, then the 3 most important improvements for my CV: [paste].

Prepare for the interview

> Based on my CV and this job post, ask me 5 likely interview questions, one at a time, and give feedback on my answers.

FAQ: Tricky Situations

"My CGPA is low."

Leave it off. Lead with skills, projects and experience instead. If an employer asks, be honest and talk briefly about what you learned or did alongside your studies.

"I have a gap, or took longer to graduate."

Short gaps don't need explaining on a CV. If asked, give a short, honest reason (health, family, preparing for exams) plus anything you did meanwhile (courses, freelancing, volunteering). Don't over-explain.

"I have zero experience."

Look again at p. 25: projects, clubs, tutoring and volunteering all count. If you truly have nothing, start one small project **this month** and publish it.

"My degree doesn't match the job I want."

Use the summary as a bridge: *"Economics graduate moving into UX research, with 2 completed user-research projects…"* Then lead with relevant projects and skills.

"Should I apply to jobs in other countries or remote jobs?"

Yes, if you meet the requirements. Add your time zone, check work-permit rules, and use international date and phone formats.

STILL STUCK?

Your university careers office, alumni and seniors in your field have answered these questions many times. Asking is normal, and often the start of a useful relationship.

FAQ: Quick Answers

Photo on my CV?	No, unless the job post asks or it's clearly the local norm.
One page or two?	One. Two only with substantial research, publications or several internships.
Include high school?	Usually not, once you have a degree.
Hobbies?	Only if they show a skill: *"Run a cooking YouTube channel with 5K subscribers"*. Skip "reading, travelling".
References on the CV?	No. Prepare 2–3 people separately and ask their permission.
Same CV for every job?	Same base, but tailor the top third every time.
Which format?	Text-based PDF, unless .docx is requested.
How many applications?	Quality first. 5–15 well-tailored applications a week, plus networking, is a strong pace.
Online courses worth listing?	Yes, if relevant and recognised (Google, Microsoft, AWS, Coursera, HubSpot). Even better with a project that uses the skill.
Lie a little?	Never. Backgrounds are checked and interviews expose it. One lie can cancel an offer.

Copy-Ready CV Template

Type this into a blank Word or Google Docs file. Replace the [brackets], delete what doesn't apply, and keep it to one page.

```
FIRSTNAME LASTNAME
[Target Job Title — copied from the job post]
+[country code] [phone] · [email] · [City, Country (time zone)]
linkedin.com/in/[name] · [portfolio / GitHub link]

SUMMARY
[Degree] graduate with [skill 1], [skill 2] and [skill 3], shown
through [internship/project] where [result with a number].
Seeking a [target role] in [type of team/industry].

SKILLS
Technical: [tool], [tool], [tool], [tool], [tool]
Methods:   [method], [method], [method]
Languages: [language (level)], [language (level)]
Certifications: [name (year)]

EDUCATION
[Full Degree Name, Major] — [University], [City]      [Mon YYYY]
CGPA [x.xx/4.00] · [Honour or award]
Relevant coursework: [course], [course], [course], [course]

EXPERIENCE
[Job Title] — [Organisation], [City/Remote]  [Mon YYYY — Mon YYYY]
• [Verb] [what] using [tool], [result with number].
• [Verb] [what] using [tool], [result with number].

PROJECTS
[Project Name] — [tools] · [link]                    [Mon YYYY]
• [What it does, for whom, measurable result].

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING
[Role] — [Organisation]                  [Mon YYYY — Mon YYYY]
• [Verb] [what], [scope or result].
```

BEFORE YOU SEND

Save as `Firstname-Lastname-Role-CV.pdf`, run the tests on p. 40, and score it with the scorecard on p. 42.

Application Tracker

Track every application in a spreadsheet (Google Sheets or Excel). It stops you losing track, shows you what works and helps you follow up on time.

COMPANY	ROLE	APPLIED	CV VERSION	CONTACT	STATUS	NEXT STEP
ShopNest	Jr Mktg Associate	3 Mar	Marketing v2	Ms Karim	Interview	Prep 10 Mar
BlueLeaf	Content Writer	5 Mar	Content v1	—	Applied	Follow up 17 Mar
Nexa Pay	Growth Intern	6 Mar	Marketing v2	Alumnus: Rafi	Referred	Thank Rafi

Status options

Saved → Applied → Followed up → Screening call → Interview → Offer / Rejected / No reply

TIP

Every two weeks, review it: which **CV version** and which **channel** (portal, email, referral) gets the most replies? Do more of that.

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

Also save the **job post** and **who you spoke to**. Recruiters are impressed when you remember their name and details from an earlier call.

Your 30-Day Action Plan

Week 1 · Foundations

- [ ] Write your master CV (p. 14)
- [ ] Build one ATS-safe base CV from the template
- [ ] Run the copy-paste and 7-second tests
- [ ] Set up a professional email and custom LinkedIn URL

Week 2 · Proof

- [ ] Pick your 3 best projects and write them up as case studies
- [ ] Publish them on GitHub, Behance, Notion or a website
- [ ] Complete your LinkedIn profile; ask for 2 recommendations

Week 3 · Visibility

- [ ] Record a 60–90 second video introduction
- [ ] List 30 contacts; send 10 friendly messages
- [ ] Publish your first LinkedIn post

Week 4 · Apply with intent

- [ ] Send 10–15 tailored applications, logged in your tracker
- [ ] Find one person at each company to connect with
- [ ] Follow up after 7–10 working days
- [ ] Score your CV with the scorecard and improve it

Got an Interview? Start Here

Your CV did its job. The interview is a conversation about it, so **know every line of your own CV** and be ready to tell the story behind it.

Before

- ☐ Re-read the job post and the CV version you sent (check your tracker)
- ☐ Research the company: what it sells, who its customers are, recent news
- ☐ Prepare 3 stories with the **STAR** method (below)
- ☐ Test your camera, microphone and internet for online interviews

> **STAR: HOW TO ANSWER "TELL ME ABOUT A TIME…"**
> **S**ituation: the context in one sentence · **T**ask: what you had to do · **A**ction: what *you* did (say "I", not "we") · **R**esult: what happened, with a number if possible

Questions graduates are almost always asked

- ✓ "Tell me about yourself." (Adapt your video script from p. 53)
- ✓ "Why this role, and why us?"
- ✓ "Tell me about a project you're proud of."
- ✓ "What's a weakness you're working on?"

WORK-CULTURE NOTE

At the end, **always ask 1–2 questions**, such as *"What does success look like in the first 3 months?"* Saying "no questions" can sound like low interest.

Worksheet: My Wins

Fill this in before you write your CV. Every line here can become a bullet point. Print it, or copy it into a document.

WHAT I DID	TOOLS / SKILLS USED	RESULT OR NUMBER

Prompts to jog your memory

- ✓ When did someone thank you, praise you or ask you to do something again?
- ✓ What did you organise, build, fix, teach or improve?
- ✓ Where did you save time or money, or reach more people?
- ✓ What's the hardest problem you solved in a course or project?

Notes

Final Words

Job hunting as a fresh graduate can feel lonely, slow and unfair. Everyone who now has a job once stood exactly where you are.

Remember

- ✓ **Your CV is a marketing document,** not a life story. Its only job is to earn a conversation.
- ✓ **Clarity beats creativity.** Simple formatting, specific results.
- ✓ **Proof beats claims.** One real project beats ten adjectives.
- ✓ **People beat portals.** One kind message can do more than fifty applications.
- ✓ **Honesty always wins** in the long run.
- ✓ **Rejection is data,** not a verdict on your worth.

ONE LAST UNWRITTEN RULE

Once you get the job, keep a "wins" note: every achievement, number and piece of praise. Your **next** CV will thank you.

Now close this book and open a blank document.
Your first page starts today.

Things I Want to Remember

Job sites I've set alerts on, people to message, deadlines, interview dates, and questions for my next CV review.

About Onnoy.

Onnoy - অন্বয় (অন্বয়: "connection") is a youth-led decision-making mentorship initiative in Mymensingh, Bangladesh. We help students, and the parents and teachers who guide them, learn *how* to decide: what to study, what to believe online, how to use new tools without giving themselves away, and now, how to step from campus into a first job.

Onnoy began in 2026 in the Changemakers' Programme of Amra Notun Network and BRAC Youth Platform. The cohort ended; the work did not. Students who finish our sessions go on to mentor others, and everything we publish is drafted, checked and tested by the team before it reaches a reader.

Why a CV guide?

Many capable graduates send CVs that no one reads. Not because they lack ability, but because nobody showed them how hiring works. This guide is our answer: plain words, real examples, and no paid templates.

Sessions

Hands-on workshops in schools, colleges and clubs. You do; we don't lecture.

Guides

Short, printable guides like this one. Free to copy for non-commercial use.

Peer mentors

People who finish a session help the next group, so the habit outlives the visit.

For parents & teachers

Plain-language material for the adults students turn to first.

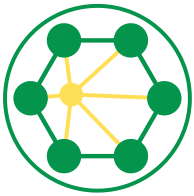
WANT A SESSION AT YOUR UNIVERSITY, COLLEGE OR CLUB?

Message us on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for Onnoy.

Team Onnoy: Connecting Necessary Dots...

Thousands apply.
Few get read.
Be one of them.

- Write a CV that **software can read** and people remember.
- Review it **like a recruiter** before anyone else does.
- Get noticed **beyond the PDF**: LinkedIn, a portfolio, and people.



Onnoy

Connecting Necessary Dots

অন্বয়

SCAN TO FIND ONNOY ON FACEBOOK

ALSO FROM ONNOY

Not Sure What to Study? · a mentor's workbook

Make Free AI Work for You · a 10-step guide

অনিমা (Onima) · a picture story about attention

Hiring software, job sites and AI tools change often. Treat every platform tip here as a prompt to check, not a rule to memorise. This edition was checked in October 2026.

FIRST EDITION · OCTOBER 2026

MYMENSINGH, BANGLADESH